

Third trimester

26 WEEKS It's the home stretch. Your belly is a source of pride, and you will marvel as it grows.



Baby watch

📏 14% in (36.6 cm) 📖 1lb 14½ oz (875 g)

Your baby's eyelids open for the very first time around now. He is sensitive to light passing through the abdominal wall, though at the moment he can see only in black, white, and grays. As the kidneys mature, more urine is produced and excreted into the amniotic sac. The waxy vernix that is coating your baby helps prevent his skin from being irritated by the urine.

Mom matters

Don't be surprised if your breasts start leaking a little fluid now. This premilk, called colostrum, is produced in pregnancy, ready for your baby right after birth. You may feel a sense of relief as your reach the third trimester.



This week...

- » Talking to your unborn baby now can kick-start the bonding process as your voice becomes familiar to him.
- » If you are suffering from hemorrhoids, keep up your fiber intake to keep stool-soft.
- » If varicose veins are a problem, wear support hose and put your feet up as much as possible.
- » Make a checklist of everything you will need for your baby. Start doing research on which big items to borrow or buy and begin purchasing things if you feel comfortable doing so.

27 WEEKS Reassuringly, babies who are born at this stage in pregnancy have a 90-percent survival rate.



Baby watch

📏 14% in (37.6 cm) 📖 2 lb 4 oz (1 kg)

Your steadily growing baby fits ever more snugly in the uterus, but he can still manage to turn and flex his limbs. Your baby's muscle and organ development is supported by amino acids (the building blocks of protein) passed on from your blood. Baby boys start to outgrow girls now. Creases form on the palms of the hands and in the tooth buds, enamel and dentine develop.

Mom matters

With the production of amniotic fluid slowing and your baby becoming increasingly active, you're likely to feel plenty of kicks. Note your baby's pattern of activities; if there are changes in his normal behavior (such as slowing down or stopping completely), you should report them to your doctor. Some women develop a pregnancy "waddle" as they grow, caused by their changing shape and the loosening of ligaments and tissues. This might become more exaggerated over the coming weeks. Many women find they become clumsier at this stage. Be careful on slippery surfaces such as the shower or bathtub.



This week...

- » Be careful with your movements to avoid straining your back.

28 WEEKS At this point, you may not remember how you felt without a belly.



Baby watch

📏 15% in (38.6 cm) 📖 2 lb 8 oz (1.2 g)

Vital development is continuing in the lungs, preparing your baby to breathe at birth. The folds of the brain have increased to house millions of new brain cells, and the cerebral cortex can send electrical impulses.

Mom matters

Your breasts are gearing up for feeding your baby. Pregnancy hormones increase the blood flow to the breasts and cause changes to the tissue, the veins become more prominent, and they may increase in size. The nipple area, or areola, also continues to grow and darken. You may notice small bumps known as Montgomery's tubercles forming around your nipples.



This week...

- » You may have an prenatal appointment this week. Your doctor may give you bloods tests to check for anemia and pregnancy-induced gestational diabetes.
- » If your blood group is Rhesus negative, you will be offered an injection called Rh immunoglobulin (Rhig) to avoid complications in this and future pregnancies.
- » If you're suffering from restless leg syndrome, avoid caffeine late in the day, and eat foods containing the amino acid tryptophan, such as pumpkin seeds and yogurt, that triggers the release of the calming brain chemical serotonin, promoting good sleep.